ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA: 3.64) in the Third Cycle)

KARAIKUDI – 630 003

30.11.2017

A team consisting of twenty-five professionals from Mauritius visited Alagappa University, Karaikudi today (29.11.2017). An Experience-Sharing Session with them was organized at the Department of Social work in association with Gandhian Society Village Association (GANSOVILLE), Amaravatipudur.

The Mauritian team visited the Tamil Culture Museum and stated that they could perceive the richness of Tamil culture and wanted to teach their children the cultural values of the Tamils. The team also met Dr.S.Subbiah, Vice-Chancellor of Alagappa University, at his chamber and interacted with him, and made a request to the Vice-Chancellor to help in promoting the teaching of Tamil by training the Tamil teachers in Mauritius and also to help in imbibing the Tamil cultural values to the children of their Country. The Vice-Chancellor expressed his willingness to initiate an MoU with the Ministry.

The Mauritians later interacted with the students and research scholars of the University and exchanged views on the social, cultural, and other problems confronting both of the countries. Referring to the problem of increasing number of old-age people in Mauritius, a delegate said that the Government of Mauritius has solved it by increasing the retirement age to sixty-five. They also highlighted the role and contribution of Social Workers and NGOs in Mauritius for the rehabilitation of drug addicts and they made a reference to the good services provided by their Government in the community health services sector. While the unemployment problem is almost nil in Mauritius, the under-employment problem prevails to some extent. Some of the members of the team being descendants of Tamil origin, they wanted to experience Tamil Culture at first-hand and wished to learn the roots of their origin. They said that their forefathers left India some 200 years ago and all of them were skilled labourers and contributed to the economic development of Mauritius. Referring to the people of Tamil Nadu, they said they could see the smartness; and the bonhomie and the hospitality that was extended to them made them realise the great cultural values of the Tamils.

Dr.K.R.Murugan, Professor and Head, Department of Social Work, Alagappa University, and Fr.A.Cyril SJ, Director, GANSOVILLE arranged the interactive sessions at the University. In his welcome address, Prof.K.R.Murugan related his rich experiences during his stay in Mauritius for six months in connection with his research work; and he added that this kind of visits would help not only in strengthening the bond between the peoples of these two countries but also help the Tamil origin people to preserve their culture for the benefit of posterity. Dr.M.Natarajan, Member, Centre for International Relations, Alagappa University, proposed a vote of thanks.

Prof. V.Balachandran

Registrar i/c